

doesn't accept checks from me. I have to pay each month's rent in a money order or cashier's check. (Sorry, Maria!)

- ° \$276 for groceries. Investopedia.com said \$500 per month per household on food in LA is average. Even adding random snacks, my total groceries cost me much less than that. My spending on restaurants varies wildly. Some months it's \$100; this month it was \$12 (a rare low for me).
- ° \$223 for car insurance. When I first looked at it in 2017, Geico was charging me \$559.85 a month for my car insurance. During the process of writing this book, I've been kicked off Geico for having three fender benders in one year (I'm the best) and now have Access for my car, which costs me \$223 a month.
- ° \$284.75 a month for health insurance.
- ° \$400 on meds and therapy.
- ° \$50 to Southern California Gas Company.
- ° \$194 to Time Warner/Spectrum.
- ° \$556 on student loans. In 2017, I was paying my three student loans: to Navient for \$338 and two through Nelnet for \$113 and \$105 a month. In 2018, I paid off the smaller ones in full and now just pay \$338 a month to Navient. (*Just*. LOL.)
- ° \$62 on personal grooming. I'm an actress who is on camera, and I used to like to have gel fingernails so they don't chip. At this point in my life, I usually got them redone every two weeks or so. Eventually I gave up getting my nails done entirely, and I don't miss it. (I also stopped dying my hair blonde, which saves me four hours and \$300 every couple of months.) Not everyone can do that or wants to do that, but that's something that opened up some extra cash for me.
- ° \$80 on parking meters and ride apps. When I lived in New York, I took the subway everywhere and had to factor in a MetroCard. Now I live in LA and I drive. I never, ever look at the parking meter. I slide my card. I hit accept, and I keep walking regardless of how much time I'll be spending at the venue. It seems silly, but maybe if I spent two seconds